

APRSaR Tracker

Legal Documents Package
Version 1.0 · Effective June 26, 2026

Document	Description
End User License Agreement	Terms of use, warranties, and license grant
Privacy Policy	Data handling, third-party services, and user rights
Acceptable Use Policy	Permitted and prohibited uses of the software
Operational Disclaimer	SAR, radio, and life-safety liability limitations
Third-Party Services Disclaimer	External API and data source disclosures
Radio Communications Policy	FCC compliance and callsign usage requirements
Subject Data Handling Notice	SAR personnel data and privacy obligations
Software License (GPL v3)	Open source license for the application code
Contributor License Agreement	Terms for code contributors via GitHub

Published by: 914 Communications · Robert W Donze — W7CTY · Indianapolis, Indiana

Legal notices: admin@914communications.co

General contact: w7cty@outlook.com

Source code: github.com/W7CTY/aprs-tracker

END USER LICENSE AGREEMENT

Effective June 26, 2026 · Version 1.0

PLEASE READ THIS END USER LICENSE AGREEMENT ("EULA") CAREFULLY BEFORE INSTALLING OR USING APRSaR TRACKER. BY INSTALLING, COPYING, OR OTHERWISE USING THE SOFTWARE, YOU AGREE TO BE BOUND BY THE TERMS OF THIS EULA. IF YOU DO NOT AGREE, DO NOT INSTALL OR USE THE SOFTWARE.

1. GRANT OF LICENSE

914 Communications ("Licensor") grants you a non-exclusive, non-transferable, revocable license to install and use APRSaR Tracker ("Software") on devices you own or control, solely for lawful purposes consistent with this EULA and all applicable laws and regulations.

2. OPEN SOURCE LICENSE

APRSaR Tracker is licensed under the GNU General Public License version 3 (GPL v3). The source code is available at github.com/W7CTY/aprs-tracker. Your rights to use, modify, and distribute the source code are governed by the GPL v3, a copy of which is included in this package. Where this EULA and the GPL v3 conflict, the GPL v3 governs with respect to source code; this EULA governs with respect to operational use, disclaimers, and liability.

3. RESTRICTIONS

You may not:

- Use the Software for any unlawful purpose or in violation of any applicable federal, state, or local law or regulation, including without limitation FCC regulations governing amateur radio operations
- Use the Software to conduct unauthorized Search and Rescue operations, false emergency activations, or any activity that could endanger public safety
- Transmit on amateur radio frequencies without holding a valid license issued by the FCC or the applicable national authority
- Enter false information into the Software, including false callsigns, fabricated subject records, or fictitious SAR operation data
- Use the Software in any jurisdiction where its use would be prohibited by law, including jurisdictions subject to US export controls and sanctions
- Attempt to reverse engineer, decompile, or disassemble any proprietary components of the Software beyond what is permitted by the GPL v3
- Represent that the Software is an official product of any government agency, emergency management organization, or entity other than 914 Communications

4. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

The Software name "APRSaR Tracker," the 914 Communications brand, and all associated trade dress are the property of 914 Communications. The underlying source code is licensed under GPL v3. Third-party libraries and data sources retain their respective licenses and attributions.

5. AGE REQUIREMENT

You must be at least 18 years of age, or hold a valid amateur radio license, to use this Software. By using the Software you represent that you meet this requirement.

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8. INDEMNIFICATION

You agree to defend, indemnify, and hold harmless 914 Communications, its owner, and contributors from and against any and all claims, damages, losses, costs, and expenses (including reasonable attorneys' fees) arising from or related to: (a) your use of the Software; (b) your violation of this EULA; (c) your violation of any applicable law or regulation, including FCC Part 97; (d) any radio transmissions you make using the Software; (e) any SAR operations or emergency response activities in which the Software is used; or (f) any third-party claims arising from your use of the Software.

9. GOVERNING LAW AND JURISDICTION

This EULA shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the State of Indiana, United States, without regard to its conflict of law provisions. Any disputes arising under this EULA shall be resolved exclusively in the state or federal courts located in Marion County, Indiana, and you consent to personal jurisdiction in those courts.

10. SEVERABILITY

If any provision of this EULA is found to be unenforceable or invalid by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be modified to the minimum extent necessary to make it enforceable, and the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.

11. ENTIRE AGREEMENT

This EULA, together with the Privacy Policy, Acceptable Use Policy, Operational Disclaimer, and all other documents in this Legal Package, constitute the entire agreement between you and 914 Communications with respect to the Software and supersede all prior agreements, representations, and understandings.

12. UPDATES TO TERMS

914 Communications reserves the right to modify these terms at any time. You will be notified of material changes via an in-app notification on next launch. Continued use of the Software after notification constitutes acceptance of the updated terms. Current terms are always available at github.com/W7CTY/aprs-tracker.

13. CONTACT

For legal notices and questions regarding this EULA: admin@914communications.co

PRIVACY POLICY

Effective June 26, 2026 · Version 1.0

1. OVERVIEW

914 Communications is committed to protecting your privacy. This Privacy Policy explains what data APRSaR Tracker ("Software") processes, where it goes, and your rights with respect to that data. 914 Communications does not operate servers, collect personal data, or store any information from your use of the Software on its own systems. All data either remains on your device or is sent directly to the third-party services described below.

2. DATA STORED ON YOUR DEVICE

The following data is stored locally on your device in the application data directory (~/.local/share/aprs-tracker/) and is never transmitted to 914 Communications:

- SAR operation records, including operation names, dates, locations, and notes
- Subject records, including names, descriptions, last known points, medical information, and photographs you attach
- Personnel roster entries, including callsigns, names, and role assignments
- Search sector drawings and probability of detection calculations
- Incident logs and T-card records
- Application settings and refresh interval preferences
- Callsign history and weather location history
- API keys you enter (RadioReference, OpenWeatherMap)
- Imported CHIRP CSV frequency data

This data is entirely under your control. You may delete it at any time by removing the application data directory. Uninstalling the Software does not automatically delete this data.

3. DATA SENT TO THIRD-PARTY SERVICES

The Software communicates with the following external services. 914 Communications has no control over the data practices of these services and is not responsible for their privacy practices. You should review their respective privacy policies.

3.1 aprs.fi

When you track a callsign or load area beacons, the callsign and your map center coordinates are sent to api.aprs.fi. Data sent: callsign queried, geographic bounding box. Purpose: retrieve APRS station positions. API key is included in requests. Privacy policy: aprs.fi

3.2 Open-Meteo

When you load weather data, your weather location coordinates are sent to api.open-meteo.com. Data sent: latitude, longitude. Purpose: retrieve weather forecast and conditions. No API key required. Privacy policy: [open-meteo.com](https://open-meteo.com/privacy-policy)

3.3 National Weather Service (NWS)

When the alert polling system runs, your weather location coordinates are sent to api.weather.gov. Data sent: latitude, longitude. Purpose: retrieve active weather alerts. No API key required. Operated by NOAA, a US government agency.

3.4 RainViewer

When the radar overlay is enabled, map tile requests are sent to tilecache.rainviewer.com and api.rainviewer.com. Data sent: map tile coordinates (zoom, x, y). Purpose: retrieve radar imagery. No API key required. Privacy policy: [rainviewer.com](https://rainviewer.com/privacy-policy)

3.5 RadioReference

When you use the repeater overlay with RadioReference credentials, your username, API key, and map center county are sent to api.radioreference.com via SOAP requests. Data sent: credentials, county name. Purpose: retrieve nearby repeater frequencies. Requires a Premium account. Privacy policy: [radioreference.com](https://radioreference.com/privacy-policy)

3.6 Nominatim / OpenStreetMap

When you enter a city/state weather location or when the repeater overlay resolves a county name, a geocoding request is sent to nominatim.openstreetmap.org. Data sent: location text or coordinates. Purpose: resolve location names to coordinates. No API key required. Privacy policy: [openstreetmap.org](https://openstreetmap.org/privacy-policy)

3.7 GitHub

On startup, the Software checks github.com/W7CTY/aprs-tracker/releases for available updates. Data sent: standard HTTPS request headers (no personal data). Purpose: check for new versions.

3.8 APRS-IS Network

When APRS-IS messaging is active, your callsign and any messages you send are transmitted to the APRS-IS network (rotate.aprs2.net or your configured server). APRS is a public network — transmissions are received and logged by third parties globally. Data sent: your callsign, message text, position if beaconing. This data is inherently public.

4. DATA YOU SHOULD PROTECT

SAR subject records may contain sensitive personal information including names, ages, medical conditions, and photographs of missing or injured persons. This data is stored only on your device, but you are responsible for:

- Securing your device against unauthorized access
- Following your agency's data retention and destruction policies

- Complying with applicable privacy laws regarding personal information of subjects
- Not sharing exported operation data containing personal information with unauthorized parties

5. CHILDREN'S PRIVACY

The Software is not intended for use by persons under 18 years of age. 914 Communications does not knowingly collect or process data from minors.

6. DATA RETENTION

914 Communications does not retain any user data. All data stored by the Software remains on your local device until you delete it. Third-party services have their own retention policies. APRS transmissions are permanently public record.

7. YOUR RIGHTS

Because 914 Communications does not collect or store your personal data, traditional data subject rights (access, correction, deletion) apply to your local device rather than to us. For data sent to third-party services, contact those services directly.

8. CHANGES TO THIS POLICY

Material changes to this Privacy Policy will be communicated via in-app notification. The current policy is always available at github.com/W7CTY/aprs-tracker.

9. CONTACT

Privacy inquiries: admin@914communications.co

ACCEPTABLE USE POLICY

Effective June 26, 2026 · Version 1.0

1. PURPOSE

APRSaR Tracker is designed for use by licensed amateur radio operators, trained Search and Rescue personnel, emergency management volunteers, and affiliated public safety professionals. This Acceptable Use Policy defines permitted and prohibited uses.

2. PERMITTED USES

- Tracking APRS-equipped stations for legitimate amateur radio, SAR, or emergency communications purposes
- Managing Search and Rescue operations by trained and authorized personnel
- Weather monitoring and NWS alert reception for personal or operational safety
- Amateur radio net operations and APRS-IS messaging by licensed operators
- Training exercises and tabletop drills when clearly identified as such
- Software development, testing, and contribution under the GPL v3
- Personal preparedness and emergency planning activities

3. PROHIBITED USES

The following uses are strictly prohibited:

- Initiating or participating in false, unauthorized, or hoax SAR activations
- Transmitting on amateur radio frequencies without a valid FCC license or equivalent national authorization
- Using another person's callsign without authorization, except as permitted under FCC rules (e.g., control operator)
- Entering false or fabricated subject data, position reports, or operational information
- Using the Software to stalk, harass, surveil, or track individuals without their knowledge and consent
- Interfering with legitimate emergency communications or public safety radio operations
- Using the Software as the sole or primary system for life-safety decisions without appropriate backup systems and human judgment
- Exporting or re-exporting the Software in violation of US export control laws
- Any use that violates applicable federal, state, or local law

4. AMATEUR RADIO COMPLIANCE

Users who transmit via the APRS-IS messaging function or any radio-connected feature of the Software must comply with FCC Part 97 rules, including:

- Station identification requirements
- Prohibited transmissions (music, obscene content, false distress signals)
- Third-party traffic rules
- Power limits and band plans
- Prohibition on encryption of message content on amateur bands

5. SAR OPERATIONAL STANDARDS

Users conducting Search and Rescue operations using this Software must:

- Hold appropriate training, certification, or authorization for SAR activities in their jurisdiction
- Follow ICS/NIMS protocols and their agency's standard operating procedures
- Not rely solely on this Software for operational decisions — it is a tool to supplement, not replace, trained human judgment
- Protect subject personal information in accordance with applicable privacy laws and agency policies
- Report mandatory reporting obligations (evidence of crime, child welfare concerns) as required by law

6. ENFORCEMENT

Violations of this Acceptable Use Policy may result in termination of your license to use the Software. Serious violations, particularly those involving public safety or FCC regulations, may be reported to appropriate authorities. To report misuse: admin@914communications.co

OPERATIONAL DISCLAIMER

Effective June 26, 2026 · Version 1.0

THIS DISCLAIMER APPLIES SPECIFICALLY TO THE USE OF APRSaR TRACKER IN SEARCH AND RESCUE, EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT, AND PUBLIC SAFETY CONTEXTS. READ THIS CAREFULLY.

1. NOT A PROFESSIONAL EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

APRSaR Tracker is a software tool designed to assist trained personnel. It is NOT a certified emergency management system, a CAD (Computer-Aided Dispatch) replacement, or a professional life-safety system. It has not been reviewed, certified, or approved by any government agency, emergency management organization, or standards body for use in life-safety applications.

2. DATA ACCURACY AND TIMELINESS

All data displayed by the Software is subject to the following limitations:

- APRS position data may be delayed, stale, or inaccurate. Station positions reflect the last received packet and may not represent current location. Packet propagation depends on digipeater infrastructure and RF conditions
- Weather data from Open-Meteo is model-derived and may not reflect actual conditions. Forecasts are probabilistic, not guaranteed
- NWS alerts are subject to propagation delays. The 90-second polling interval means alerts may appear up to 90 seconds after issuance. Alert boundaries are approximate
- Radar imagery from RainViewer is updated approximately every 10 minutes and may not reflect rapidly developing weather
- Repeater data from RadioReference is user-submitted and may be outdated, incorrect, or missing
- Search probability calculations (POD, POA) are mathematical estimates based on inputs you provide. They do not guarantee subject location

3. HUMAN JUDGMENT IS REQUIRED

No output from this Software should be acted upon without the exercise of trained human judgment. The Incident Commander, Search Manager, or other qualified personnel must independently verify critical information before making operational decisions. The Software is a decision support tool, not a decision-making system.

4. SYSTEM AVAILABILITY

The Software depends on internet connectivity for weather, alerts, APRS data, and radar. In the field environments where SAR operations occur, internet connectivity may be unavailable, unreliable, or intermittent. Do not assume the Software will be operational in remote areas. Always maintain offline backup systems and paper-based alternatives.

5. NO WARRANTY FOR LIFE-SAFETY USE

914 COMMUNICATIONS EXPRESSLY DISCLAIMS ANY WARRANTY THAT THIS SOFTWARE IS SUITABLE, RELIABLE, OR SAFE FOR USE IN LIFE-SAFETY APPLICATIONS. USE IN SAR OPERATIONS, EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT, OR ANY CONTEXT WHERE FAILURE COULD RESULT IN INJURY OR DEATH IS ENTIRELY AT THE OPERATOR'S OWN RISK. 914 COMMUNICATIONS SHALL NOT BE LIABLE FOR ANY OUTCOME, INCLUDING INJURY, DEATH, OR PROPERTY DAMAGE, ARISING FROM RELIANCE ON THIS SOFTWARE IN ANY OPERATIONAL CONTEXT.

6. BETA AND DEVELOPMENT VERSIONS

Versions of the Software below version 6.0.0 are in active development. Features may be incomplete, unstable, or produce incorrect results. Beta and preview releases should not be used as primary systems in active SAR operations. Production operations should use the latest stable release.

7. CONTACT

Operational concerns or safety-related feedback: admin@914communications.co

THIRD-PARTY SERVICES DISCLAIMER

Effective June 26, 2026 · Version 1.0

1. OVERVIEW

APRSaR Tracker integrates with several third-party data services to provide weather, APRS tracking, radar, and repeater information. 914 Communications is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or responsible for any of these services. Their availability, accuracy, and terms of service may change at any time without notice to 914 Communications or to you.

2. SERVICE ATTRIBUTIONS AND DISCLAIMERS

aprs.fi

Provides APRS station position data. APRS data is crowd-sourced from a global network of volunteer stations and digipeaters. Position accuracy depends on the transmitting station's GPS and the receiving infrastructure. Data may be delayed or absent in areas with poor RF coverage.

Open-Meteo (open-meteo.com)

Provides weather forecast data using numerical weather prediction models. Forecasts are probabilistic estimates and may differ from actual conditions, particularly in rapidly changing weather situations.

National Weather Service / NOAA (weather.gov)

Provides official US weather alerts. Alert geographic boundaries are polygon-based approximations. Alert issuance depends on NWS operational systems and may be delayed or unavailable during system outages.

RainViewer (rainviewer.com)

Provides radar imagery derived from weather radar networks. The public API is limited to zoom level 7 and updates approximately every 10 minutes. Radar data may not reflect rapidly developing precipitation.

RadioReference (radioreference.com)

Provides repeater frequency data. Data is user-submitted and may be outdated, incorrect, or incomplete. Requires a paid Premium account. RadioReference is not affiliated with 914 Communications.

Nominatim / OpenStreetMap (openstreetmap.org)

Provides geocoding (converting location names to coordinates). Coverage and accuracy vary by region. Subject to OpenStreetMap's Nominatim usage policy.

GitHub (github.com)

Hosts the Software source code and releases. Update checking contacts GitHub's releases API. GitHub is a product of Microsoft Corporation.

APRS-IS Network

The Automatic Packet Reporting System Internet Service is a global volunteer-operated network. Packet delivery is not guaranteed. The network is subject to congestion, outages, and filter changes by network operators.

3. SERVICE AVAILABILITY

914 Communications does not guarantee the availability of any third-party service and shall not be liable for service outages, rate limiting, API changes, or discontinuation of any integrated service. If a service becomes unavailable or changes its terms in a way that affects the Software, 914 Communications will endeavor to update the Software but makes no commitment as to timeline.

4. THIRD-PARTY TERMS OF SERVICE

Your use of data from these services is subject to their respective terms of service. By using the Software, you agree to comply with the applicable terms of each service whose data you access.

RADIO COMMUNICATIONS POLICY

Effective June 26, 2026 · Version 1.0

1. LICENSE REQUIREMENT

APRSaR Tracker includes features that facilitate amateur radio transmissions, including APRS-IS messaging and APRS beacon transmission. These features result in actual radio transmissions when connected to a radio or gateway. You must hold a valid amateur radio license issued by the FCC (or the applicable national licensing authority in your country) to use these features. 914 Communications does not verify license status and accepts no liability for unlicensed transmissions.

2. FCC PART 97 COMPLIANCE

All transmissions facilitated by this Software on amateur radio frequencies must comply with FCC Part 97, including but not limited to:

- 47 CFR §97.119 — Station identification
- 47 CFR §97.113 — Prohibited transmissions (no false or deceptive signals, no music, no obscene content)
- 47 CFR §97.115 — Third-party communications
- 47 CFR §97.309 — AFSK, FSK, and other digital emissions
- 47 CFR §97.311 — Spread spectrum and other emission types

3. CALLSIGN USAGE

You may enter only callsigns that you are authorized to use. Authorized callsigns include:

- Your own FCC-issued callsign
- A callsign for which you are the designated control operator under FCC rules
- A club callsign for which you are an authorized trustee or operator

Entering another person's callsign into the tracking field for monitoring purposes (not transmission) is permitted. Transmitting under a callsign you are not authorized to use is a violation of FCC rules and this policy.

4. APRS AS A PUBLIC NETWORK

APRS is a public communications system. All APRS packets you transmit, including position reports, messages, and objects, are received and logged by third parties globally and are permanently public record. Do not transmit sensitive or private information over APRS. Subject location information transmitted via APRS during a SAR operation should be treated as publicly disclosed.

5. EXPORT CONTROL NOTICE

This Software includes cryptographic components used for mesh network communications. It is subject to the US Export Administration Regulations (EAR). You may not export, re-export, or transfer the Software to any country, person, or entity that is subject to US trade sanctions or export control restrictions, including countries listed on the OFAC Sanctions List or the BIS Entity List.

6. CONTACT

Radio compliance questions: admin@914communications.co

SUBJECT DATA HANDLING NOTICE

Effective June 26, 2026 · Version 1.0

1. NATURE OF SUBJECT DATA

APRSaR Tracker allows users to create records for SAR subjects — individuals who are missing, injured, or otherwise the focus of a search operation. These records may include highly sensitive personal information:

- Full name, age, physical description, and photograph
- Medical conditions, medications, and mental health information
- Last known location and movement history
- Family contact information
- Behavioral history relevant to the search

2. LOCAL STORAGE ONLY

Subject data is stored exclusively on your local device. It is never transmitted to 914 Communications or any third party by the Software. You are solely responsible for the security, access control, and appropriate handling of this information.

3. YOUR OBLIGATIONS

As the operator entering and maintaining subject data, you are responsible for:

- Obtaining appropriate authorization to collect and process personal information about subjects, in accordance with your agency's policies and applicable law
- Protecting device security against unauthorized access to subject records
- Following your agency's data retention and destruction policies — the Software does not impose automatic deletion
- Complying with applicable privacy laws, including state privacy statutes and HIPAA if medical information is involved
- Limiting access to subject records to authorized personnel
- Reporting mandatory reporting obligations as required by law (suspected child abuse, evidence of crime, etc.)

4. FIRST-USE ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The Software will display a one-time notice when you create your first subject record, confirming that you understand the sensitive nature of this data and your obligations regarding it.

5. DATA EXPORT

When you export operation data (PDF after-action reports, CSV exports, printed briefings), the resulting files may contain subject personal information. Treat exported files with the same care as the original records. Do not share exported files containing personal information with unauthorized parties.

6. NamUs AND EXTERNAL DATABASES

If NamUs integration is enabled in a future version, searches against the National Missing and Unidentified Persons System are subject to NamUs terms of service. No subject data from the Software is automatically submitted to NamUs or any other database.

SOFTWARE LICENSE

GNU General Public License Version 3 · Summary

APRSaR Tracker is free software: you can redistribute it and/or modify it under the terms of the GNU General Public License as published by the Free Software Foundation, either version 3 of the License, or (at your option) any later version.

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KEY PERMISSIONS AND CONDITIONS

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- You may modify the Software and distribute modified versions, provided you also release the source code of your modifications under GPL v3
- You may not impose additional restrictions on recipients' exercise of the rights granted by the GPL v3
- You must include a copy of the GPL v3 license with any distribution
- You must include prominent notices stating that you have modified the Software
- The full GPL v3 license text is available at gnu.org/licenses/gpl-3.0 and in the Software repository at github.com/W7CTY/aprs-tracker

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The APRSaR Tracker name, 914 Communications brand, and associated trade dress are proprietary to 914 Communications and are not licensed under GPL v3. Derivative works may not use the APRSaR Tracker name or 914 Communications branding without written permission.

CONTRIBUTOR LICENSE AGREEMENT

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This Contributor License Agreement ("CLA") applies to any contribution you submit to the APRSaR Tracker project at github.com/W7CTY/aprs-tracker. By submitting a pull request, patch, or other contribution, you agree to the following terms.

1. DEFINITIONS

"Contribution" means any original work of authorship, including modifications or additions to existing work, that you intentionally submit for inclusion in the Software.

"You" means the individual or legal entity submitting the Contribution. "Project" means the APRSaR Tracker software project maintained by 914 Communications.

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You represent and warrant that:

- You are legally entitled to grant the above licenses
- Your Contribution is your original creation, or you have sufficient rights to submit it
- Your Contribution does not include any third-party material that would conflict with the GPL v3 or this CLA
- If you are submitting on behalf of an employer, you have obtained the employer's authorization
- Your Contribution does not contain malicious code, backdoors, or security vulnerabilities you are aware of

5. DISCLAIMER

Your Contribution is provided "AS IS" without warranty of any kind. You are not expected to provide support for your Contribution.

6. CONTACT

CLA questions and legal notices regarding contributions: admin@914communications.co

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